

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Incident Response | Threat Hunting | CrowdStrike Falcon | Microsoft Sentinel

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience leading complex security investigations, incident response and advanced threat hunting across large enterprise environments. I bring deep hands-on expertise in CrowdStrike Falcon (Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Prevent, Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), Insight and Discover), Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and I am highly proficient in Kusto Query Language (KQL) for building advanced detections and hunting for attacker activity aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I take ownership of complex investigations from initial alert through to containment, eradication and post-incident review, and I am experienced acting as the senior technical escalation point within security operations. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring strong scripting and automation capability using PowerShell, having delivered enterprise security operations improvements and detection engineering programmes at the University of the Arts London (UAL), a large and complex higher education institution. I am comfortable coordinating with offshore and distributed security resources during major incidents and communicating findings clearly to senior stakeholders.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Threat Hunting and Incident Response:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Microsoft Sentinel, KQL-based threat hunting, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection, NIST 800-61 incident response, digital forensics triage, containment and eradication
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, KQL analytics rules, detection content development, alert tuning and false positive reduction, SOAR automation
- **Forensic Investigation:** Endpoint forensics, log analysis, artefact collection, memory analysis, attack timeline reconstruction, chain of custody
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), identity threat detection
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), risk-based remediation prioritisation
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, automation of investigation workflows
- **Email and Perimeter Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony, Microsoft Defender for Office 365
- **Frameworks and Standards:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST 800-61, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Act as the senior technical escalation point for complex security incidents, leading investigations from initial alert through to containment, eradication and post-incident review using CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender

- Conduct advanced threat hunting operations using Kusto Query Language (KQL) in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, proactively identifying attacker activity mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques across endpoint, identity and network telemetry
- Lead forensic investigations across endpoint and identity data sources, reconstructing attack timelines and producing evidence-based incident reports for technical and executive audiences
- Develop and maintain custom KQL detection analytics and correlation rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving signal fidelity and reducing false positive rates across enterprise detection content
- Own incident response lifecycle in accordance with NIST 800-61, coordinating containment actions and communicating with senior stakeholders throughout major cyber security events
- Manage and tune CrowdStrike Falcon EDR policies and alert configurations across 8,000+ endpoints, reducing attacker dwell time and improving detection coverage
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), detecting and investigating anomalous privileged account activity as part of identity threat detection operations
- Develop PowerShell-based Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to accelerate investigation workflows and automate routine triage tasks, reducing mean time to respond to high-priority alerts
- Coordinate vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), validating detection coverage and remediating control gaps identified through simulated attack exercises

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Delivered an enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, building detection and response capability from the ground up
- Triage and investigated security alerts from CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender, escalating high-priority incidents and coordinating response with infrastructure and management teams
- Developed KQL threat hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel to identify indicators of compromise and attacker behaviours across endpoint, identity and network event data
- Implemented and managed CrowdStrike Falcon Discover and Insight modules for continuous asset visibility, lateral movement detection and risk-based prioritisation across enterprise endpoints
- Produced incident response reports and post-incident reviews, documenting root cause analysis, remediation actions and recommendations to reduce recurrence
- Automated security operations workflows using PowerShell scripting, streamlining alert triage, threat investigation and routine security tasks
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement and privileged identity governance, supporting identity threat detection and anomalous access investigations
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance activities, maintaining security policies, controls documentation and audit evidence

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Implemented and maintained endpoint security controls and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) alerting for a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech environment, providing continuous monitoring of threats across cloud and on-premise infrastructure
- Performed security monitoring, alert triage and initial incident investigation, escalating confirmed incidents and supporting containment and remediation activities
- Administered identity and access management (IAM) controls including MFA and Single Sign-On (SSO) configuration, enforcing access policies for internal and external users
- Contributed to vulnerability management and patch management processes, ensuring timely identification and remediation of security weaknesses
- Supported delivery of security improvements aligned to NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) and CIS Controls, documenting procedures and maintaining security configurations

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led enterprise-wide 8,000-user Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender deployment, establishing a mature detection and response capability across a complex multi-site environment
- Developed advanced KQL detection analytics in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, improving detection of high-risk techniques including lateral movement, credential access and defence evasion
- Deployed Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) platform, enabling continuous validation of detection coverage and driving data-driven improvement of security controls
- Built PowerShell SOAR automation for alert triage and incident response workflows, reducing mean time to respond to critical alerts and freeing analyst capacity for complex investigations
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), materially reducing the privileged account attack surface and supporting compliance with least-privilege access principles
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, validating the organisation's security baseline against the UK Government's core controls framework

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)